

Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Ideology and End of Ideology

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 The Dual Meaning and Political Work of Ideology

2 Essential Vocabulary of Ideology Critique

3 The Chapter Spine: Distortion, Mobilisation and Closure

4 Theory, Ideology, Utopia and Open Inquiry

5 From Tracy and Bacon to Marx and Lenin

6 Lukacs, Mannheim, Popper and Arendt

7 The End-of-Ideology Proponents

8 Critics, Technocracy, Comparison and Trap Repair

9 Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture

10 Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Generation: learner-v2:g3 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Ideology (set of ideas)**?

A. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29). B. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30). C. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics. D. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaubu, PDF pp.33-34).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology (set of ideas)** with **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)**.

A. Karl Popper B. Ideology (set of ideas) C. Relation to politics D. Sociology of knowledge

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)** with **Ideology (set of ideas)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Ideology (science of ideas)**?

A. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaubu, PDF pp.28, 30-31). B. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31). C. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31). D. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaubu, PDF p.35).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology (science of ideas)** with **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)**.

A. Hannah Arendt B. Relation to authority C. Critical theory D. Ideology (science of ideas)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31)**. with **Ideology (science of ideas)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sociology of knowledge**?

A. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31). B. Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32). C. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31). D. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sociology of knowledge** with **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31)**.

A. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset B. Sociology of knowledge C. Main risk D. Open society

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31)**. with **Sociology of knowledge**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Critical theory**?

A. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34). B. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33). C. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31). D. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Critical theory** with **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31)**.

A. Basic orientation B. Ideology (set of ideas) C. Ideology vs theory D. Critical theory

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31)**. with **Critical theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Open society**?

- A. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35).
B. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36). C. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaubu, PDF p.33). D. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Open society** with **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35)**.

- A. Temper of mind B. Open society C. Ideology (science of ideas) D. Set of ideas vs science of ideas

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35)** with **Open society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Ideology vs theory**?

- A. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics. B. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaubu, PDF pp.33-34). C. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30). D. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaubu, PDF p.32).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology vs theory** with **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30)**.

- A. Relation to politics B. Sociology of knowledge C. Closed mind vs open mind D. Ideology vs theory

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30)** with **Ideology vs theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Set of ideas vs science of ideas**?

- A. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaubu, PDF pp.28, 30-31). B. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31). C. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaubu, PDF p.35). D. Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaubu, PDF pp.29, 32).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Set of ideas vs science of ideas** with **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31)**.

A. Relation to authority B. Set of ideas vs science of ideas C. Critical theory D. Ideology vs utopia

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31)** with **Set of ideas vs science of ideas**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Closed mind vs open mind**?

A. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31). B. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35). C. Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32). D. Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Closed mind vs open mind** with **Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32)**.

A. Main risk B. Open society C. Open society vs totalitarian society D. Closed mind vs open mind

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32)** with **Closed mind vs open mind**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Ideology vs utopia**?

A. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34). B. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33). C. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39). D. Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology vs utopia** with **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaubu, PDF p.34).**

A. Ideology (set of ideas) B. Ideology vs utopia C. Ideology vs theory D. Historical thesis vs settled fact

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaubu, PDF p.34).** with **Ideology vs utopia**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Open society vs totalitarian society**?

A. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaubu, PDF p.33). B. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32). C. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36). D. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Open society vs totalitarian society** with **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36).**

A. Ideology (science of ideas) B. Set of ideas vs science of ideas C. Destutt de Tracy D. Open society vs totalitarian society

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36).** with **Open society vs totalitarian society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Historical thesis vs settled fact**?

A. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics. B. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaubu, PDF pp.33-34). C. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaubu, PDF p.32). D. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Historical thesis vs settled fact** with **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.**

A. Sociology of knowledge B. Historical thesis vs settled fact C. Closed mind vs open mind D. Francis Bacon

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.** with **Historical thesis vs settled fact.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Destutt de Tracy**?

A. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35). B. Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaub, PDF pp.29, 32). C. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31). D. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Destutt de Tracy** with **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31).**

A. Critical theory B. Ideology vs utopia C. Karl Marx D. Destutt de Tracy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31).** with **Destutt de Tracy.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Francis Bacon**?

A. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31). B. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35). C. Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32). D. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Francis Bacon** with **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31).**

A. Open society B. Francis Bacon C. Open society vs totalitarian society D. V.I. Lenin

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31).** with **Francis Bacon.**

The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Karl Marx**?

- A. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39). B. Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36). C. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33). D. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Marx** with **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)**.

- A. Ideology vs theory B. Historical thesis vs settled fact C. Karl Mannheim D. Karl Marx

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)** with **Karl Marx**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **V.I. Lenin**?

- A. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33). B. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32). C. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaub, PDF pp.28-29). D. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **V.I. Lenin** with **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33)**.

- A. Set of ideas vs science of ideas B. V.I. Lenin C. Destutt de Tracy D. Karl Popper

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33)** with **V.I. Lenin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Karl Mannheim**?

- A. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32). B. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31). C. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaub, PDF

pp.33-34). D. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gauba, PDF pp.28, 30-31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Mannheim** with **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis** (Gauba, PDF pp.33-34).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis** (Gauba, PDF pp.33-34).

A. Closed mind vs open mind B. Francis Bacon C. Hannah Arendt D. Karl Mannheim

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis** (Gauba, PDF pp.33-34). with **Karl Mannheim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Karl Popper**?

A. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gauba, PDF p.35). B. Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gauba, PDF pp.29, 32). C. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gauba, PDF p.31). D. Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gauba, PDF p.32).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Popper** with **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism** (Gauba, PDF p.35).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism** (Gauba, PDF p.35).

A. Ideology vs utopia B. Karl Popper C. Karl Marx D. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism** (Gauba, PDF p.35). with **Karl Popper**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Hannah Arendt**?

A. Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gauba, PDF p.32). B. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gauba, PDF p.31). C. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gauba, PDF p.35). D. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gauba, PDF p.34).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hannah Arendt** with **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness** (Gauba, PDF p.35).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).**

A. Open society vs totalitarian society B. V.I. Lenin C. Basic orientation D. Hannah Arendt

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).** with **Hannah Arendt**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset**?

A. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39). B. Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36). C. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35). D. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset** with **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).**

A. Historical thesis vs settled fact B. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset C. Karl Mannheim D. Temper of mind

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).** with **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Basic orientation**?

A. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaub, PDF pp.28-29). B. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30). C. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32). D. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Basic orientation** with **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32).**

A. Destutt de Tracy B. Karl Popper C. Relation to politics D. Basic orientation

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32)** with **Basic orientation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Temper of mind**?

A. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32). B. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31). C. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31). D. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Temper of mind** with **Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32)**.

A. Francis Bacon B. Temper of mind C. Hannah Arendt D. Relation to authority

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32)** with **Temper of mind**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Relation to politics**?

A. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31). B. Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32). C. Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaub, PDF pp.29, 32). D. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaub, PDF p.31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Relation to politics** with **Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaub, PDF pp.29, 32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaub, PDF pp.29, 32)**.

A. Karl Marx B. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset C. Main risk D. Relation to politics

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Instrument of politics and mobilization (Gaub, PDF pp.29, 32)** with **Relation to politics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Relation to authority**?

A. Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32). B. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31). C. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34). D. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Relation to authority** with **Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32)**.

A. V.I. Lenin B. Relation to authority C. Basic orientation D. Ideology (set of ideas)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Often demands subordination to authority or cause (Gaub, PDF p.32)** with **Relation to authority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Main risk**?

A. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35).
B. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36). C. Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36). D. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Main risk** with **Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36)**.

A. Karl Mannheim B. Temper of mind C. Ideology (science of ideas) D. Main risk

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Distortion, dogma, selective truth and conflict (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30, 35-36)** with **Main risk**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain the two principal meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Ideology has a dual meaning: it may denote an organised body of political ideas, and it may denote inquiry into how ideas arise, become distorted and serve social interests.

Core analysis: In the first sense, ideology supplies identity, justification and a programme of action to a group. In the second, beginning with the science-of-ideas tradition and later critique, attention shifts to the social production of consciousness. Political theory differs because it subjects claims to evidence, conceptual clarification and normative criticism instead of merely securing commitment. Ideology asks adherents to mobilise around a view of order; theory asks whether that view is coherent and justified.

Critical evaluation: The distinction must remain qualified. A political theory can acquire an ideological function when its assumptions are insulated from criticism, while an ideology may contain genuine emancipatory insight.

Conclusion: Ideology may describe an organised idea-system or the study of socially distorted thought, but it differs from theory whenever commitment is insulated from critical testing.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: How does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Marx and Lenin both connect ideas with class struggle, but they assign a different range and political function to ideology.

Core analysis: For Marx, ideology chiefly expresses false consciousness: ruling ideas present historically contingent relations of domination as natural or universal because they reflect dominant material interests. The concept is therefore mainly diagnostic and pejorative. Lenin broadens the term. Since spontaneous worker consciousness may remain within bourgeois limits, the proletariat also requires a systematic socialist ideology capable of organising emancipatory struggle. Ideology is no longer only the mask of domination; it can also become a weapon of class transformation.

Critical evaluation: Lenin's extension solves the problem of mobilisation but creates a new danger: a party may claim privileged access to correct consciousness and suppress internal criticism.

Conclusion: Marx's pejorative account explains domination through false consciousness, whereas Lenin also treats ideology as a necessary vehicle of emancipatory class consciousness.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Examine Mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Mannheim generalises ideology critique by arguing that thought is socially situated rather than treating distortion as a defect of only the ruling class.

Core analysis: He distinguishes ideology, which tends to conserve an existing order, from utopia, which inspires groups seeking radical change. Both can become partial because social location shapes what appears plausible and important. Sociology of knowledge therefore studies the relation between ideas and their social setting. Mannheim proposes a relatively free-floating intelligentsia capable of synthesising partial perspectives and moving toward a more

comprehensive judgment.

Further development: His contribution is strongest when used comparatively: instead of dismissing an opponent as simply irrational, the analyst reconstructs the social horizon that makes a belief persuasive. Yet the genetic fallacy must be avoided. Explaining where a belief came from does not establish whether it is true. The synthesis must therefore remain a hypothesis tested through public criticism.

Critical evaluation: The proposal remains vulnerable. Social origin does not by itself establish the validity or falsity of an idea, and the intelligentsia cannot simply stand outside every social location. Relational understanding must still be tested through reasons and evidence.

Conclusion: Mannheim powerfully socialises knowledge, but his appeal to a relatively detached intelligentsia does not fully solve the problem of how socially situated judgment can claim validity.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss Popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Popper and Arendt analyse the point at which ideology ceases to be one contestable political perspective and becomes an instrument of total domination.

Core analysis: Popper defends the open society, where institutions permit criticism, error correction and piecemeal reform. Ideologies claiming final historical truth close inquiry and justify coercion against dissent. Arendt shows how totalitarianism fuses an all-explanatory ideology with terror, organisation and the isolation of uprooted masses. Ideology supplies deductive certainty; terror forces reality to conform to that alleged logic. Both accounts therefore connect political freedom with plurality and the possibility of revising belief.

Further development: Popper's emphasis is institutional and epistemic: fallibility requires criticism and reversible reform. Arendt's emphasis is historical and political: atomisation, terror and total organisation make the ideological fiction socially operative. Their accounts converge on closure but differ in mechanism. This distinction prevents the loose conclusion that every strong political belief is totalitarian.

Critical evaluation: Their target is not every political commitment. Democratic politics cannot be value-free; the danger arises when one doctrine monopolises truth and destroys the institutions of contestation.

Conclusion: Both expose the danger of monopoly truth, but the lasting lesson is not ideology-free politics; it is the institutional protection of criticism, plurality and revisability.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Critically evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and the objections raised against it. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The end-of-ideology thesis claimed that the great doctrinal conflicts of industrial society had lost force in affluent Western democracies.

Core analysis: Bell, Dahrendorf and Lipset associated this change with welfare-state compromise, mixed economy, pluralism and the institutional containment of industrial conflict. Rostow offered a developmental language that appeared to transcend ideological systems, while Galbraith emphasised managerial and technical decision-making. Critics such as Titmuss, Wright Mills, Macpherson and MacIntyre replied that the thesis converted one historically specific liberal settlement into a universal endpoint. By treating prevailing institutions as neutral, it concealed continuing inequalities and defended the status quo.

Further development: The thesis also confuses reduced doctrinal polarisation with the disappearance of ideology. Welfare compromise can narrow conflict while leaving disputes over ownership, participation and global inequality

unresolved. Galbraith's technostructure strengthens the critics' case because managerial power may operate without mass ideological rhetoric. The thesis should therefore be treated as a historically bounded diagnosis of affluent Western societies, not a universal law. Its continued value lies in prompting inquiry into where ideology migrates when political language becomes managerial. Recurrent conflict over distribution further weakens any final-end claim.

Critical evaluation: The thesis identifies a real period of convergence but overstates its permanence. Managerial language can relocate ideology into apparently technical choices rather than abolish it.

Conclusion: The thesis captured a limited period of Western convergence, yet its own status-quo assumptions confirm that ideological conflict was displaced rather than ended.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Is technocratic managerialism ideologically neutral? Discuss with reference to the end-of-ideology debate. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Technocratic managerialism presents public decisions as questions for administrators and experts rather than conflicts among rival social purposes.

Core analysis: Galbraith's account helps explain why ideology may appear to decline: complex organisations transfer power to specialised managerial and technical elites, and policy is justified through efficiency, expertise and problem-solving. Expertise is indispensable for selecting workable means, but it cannot independently decide whose welfare counts, how risks should be distributed or which ends are legitimate. These are evaluative and political questions. The critics of the end-of-ideology thesis therefore argue that technical language may naturalise a particular distribution of power.

Further development: The strongest defence of technocracy is competence: specialised problems require knowledge that plebiscitary opinion cannot supply. The reply is that democratic control need not replace expertise; it must determine mandates, disclose assumptions and make experts accountable. Titmuss, Wright Mills, Macpherson and MacIntyre expose the residual issue: who defines efficiency and whose losses are treated as unavoidable. A sound settlement separates expert authority over means from public justification of ends, while recognising that even the means can embody distributional choices. Public reason-giving and institutional contestability must therefore accompany specialised administration.

Critical evaluation: Technocracy is neutral only within goals already chosen. When it conceals those prior choices or excludes public contestation, it performs an ideological function.

Conclusion: Technocratic expertise can improve means, but it becomes ideological when contested distributions of power are presented as merely technical necessities.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.